

Terms of Reference for Consulting Services on Food Value Chain Improvement Project

Chapter 1. Background

The Government of the People's Republic of Bangladesh has received a loan from the Japan International Cooperation Agency (hereinafter referred to as "JICA") to finance Food Value Chain Improvement Project which is to improve credit access for agribusiness and food processing industries and enhance the quality and productivity of processed products by providing concessional loans for their facility investment and working capital, thereby contributing to improvement of the whole food value chain in Bangladesh.

The Government of the People's Republic of Bangladesh also intends to use part of the proceeds of the loan for eligible payments for consulting services for which this ToR is issued.

The outline of the Project is as follows:

- Executing Agency: Bangladesh Infrastructure Finance Fund Limited (hereinafter referred to as "BIFFL")
- Major output: To provide medium and long-term loans to agribusiness and food processing companies through BIFFL
- Expected project completion: September 2026

Chapter 2. Objectives of Consulting Services

The consulting services shall be provided by consulting firm(s) (hereinafter referred to as "the Consultant") in compliance with Guidelines for the Employment of Consultants under Japanese ODA Loans, April 2012. The objective of the consulting services is to achieve the efficient and proper preparation and implementation of the Project through the following works:

- A. Technical supports for TSL
- B. Technical supports for potential end-borrowers
- C. Coordination, public relations, promotion and marketing of the project

Chapter 3. Scope of Consulting Services

A. Technical Support for TSL

(1) Technical Support for Project Management

The Consultant shall

- (a) Assist BIFFL in facilitating effective management of the Project and control of the funds.

- (b) Assist the fund planning arrangement for the future operation, including (i) forecasting funds requirement on quarterly basis, (ii) requesting JICA disbursement based on the above-mentioned forecast quarterly basis/ preparation of necessary documents.
- (c) Assist BIFFL to prepare and submit reports on TSL implementation;
 - i) Quarterly Progress Report (To be submitted quarterly)
 - Project Status Report
 - Time-bound Action Plan
 - Sub-project Status Report
 - Appraisal Process Status Report
 - On-site Physical Inspection Report
 - ii) On-going Sub-project Summary Report (Yearly)
 - iii) Current Repayment and Overdue Status Report (Yearly)
 - iv) Subproject report on monitoring indicators (Yearly)
 - v) Project Completion Report (To be submitted after all disbursements to end-borrowers have been completed).

(2) Technical Supports for Sector Analysis

The Consultant shall

- (a) Assist BIFFL to analyze the market trend of agribusiness and food processing industries including identification of the potential sectors.
- (b) Assist BIFFL to analyze the characteristics and credit risks of agribusiness and food processing industries.
- (c) Assist BIFFL to identify the analytical viewpoints on food safety management of potential and existing borrowers upon loan appraisal and loan monitoring.
- (d) Assist BIFFL to review the appropriateness of the equipment to be procured by borrowers.
- (e) Organize workshop, seminars or on-the-job training for BIFFL to facilitate the understanding on food safety and food processing (including food safety certifications).

(3) Technical Supports for monitoring and evaluation activities of the of TSL

The Consultant shall

- (a) Assist BIFFL to conduct site visit/physical verifications to the subprojects financed by BIFFL to gather information on the installation, operation and maintenance status, appropriate use of the fund and compliance with food safety requirements.
- (b) Assist BIFFL to develop the framework to monitor sub-projects and
- (c) Assist BIFFL in conducting baseline and endline assessment through interviews and on-site visits on topics of; including but not limited to

- Number of suppliers and customers of end-borrowers,
- Number of certifications and licenses relating to food safety
- Amount of purchases of agricultural products of end-borrowers from contract farmers, and Improvement in the food safety management of the benefited food processing companies

B. Technical Supports for Potential End-borrowers

1) Capacity development on food safety management (basic training course)

The Consultant shall

- Assist BIFFL and Bangladesh Food Safety Authority (BFSA) to formulate training/seminar materials of food safety management basic training course on topics of, including but not limited to, regulatory requirements and necessary actions on food safety management,
- Assist BIFFL and BFSA to arrange resource persons as lectures for the food safety management basic training course, and
- Assist BIFFL and BFSA to organize the food safety management basic training course for candidate and existing end-borrowers at least twice a year for five years at Dhaka & Chattagaram.

2) Capacity development on food safety management (Advanced training course)

The Consultant shall

- Assist BIFFL and Bangladesh Agro-Processors' Association (BAPA) to formulate training/seminar materials (including course curriculum and evaluation materials) of food safety management advanced training course on topics including but not limited to
 - > Food safety and international trend,
 - > Factory operation, and
 - > Hygienic Engineering Design,
- Assist BIFFL and BAPA to arrange resource persons as lectures for the food safety management advanced training course, and
- Assist BIFFL and BAPA to organize the food safety management advanced training course at least twice a year for five years

3) Capacity development on food processing and business development

The Consultant shall

- (a) Assist BIFFL, Small and Medium Enterprise Foundation (SMEF), and Bangladesh Small and Cottage Industries Corporation (BSCIC) to formulate training/seminar materials of food processing in the area, including but not limited to
 - Quality improvement (including contract farming) and processing techniques and facilities
 - Cold chain management, and
 - Productivity improvement.
- (b) Assist BIFFL, SMEF, and BSCIC to formulate training/seminar materials on the enhancement of financial access of small and medium agribusiness and food processing companies in the area, including but not limited to
 - Formulation of investment planning/business planning, and
 - Regulatory procedures required upon loan applications (such as BSTI certificates, trade license and other certifications)
- (c) Assist BIFFL, SMEF, and BSCIC to arrange resource persons as lecturers for the training course on food processing and business development
- (d) Assist BIFFL, SMEF, and BSCIC to organize the training course on food processing and business development at least twice a year for throughout the Project period at three locations

4) Capacity development on food processing of baked goods and edible oil

The Consultant shall

- (a) Assist BIFFL and Bangladesh Small & Cottage industries Limited (BSCIC) to formulate training/seminar materials for training course on the enhancement of food processing of baked goods and edible oil,
- (b) Assist BIFFL and BSCIC to arrange resource persons as lectures for the training course on the enhancement of food processing of baked goods and edible oil, and
- (c) Assist BIFFL and BSCIC to organize the training course on the enhancement of food processing of baked goods and edible oil at least twice a year for five years at Dhaka & Chattagaram.

5) Technical supports on the enhancement of value addition of Bangladeshi food processing industries

The Consultant shall

- (a) Assist BIFFL and BAPA to organize an overseas study tour during the Project period for related government officials, personnel from food processing companies to enhance their knowledge in food processing and food safety management,
- (b) Assist BIFFL and BAPA to organize business matching seminars for Bangladeshi food processing companies domestically and globally once in the Project period respectively, and
- (c) Assist BIFFL and BAPA to support Bangladeshi food processing companies to participate in international exhibition events three times during the Project period, which will include but not be limited to
 - International Food Machinery & Technology Exhibition (FOOMA JAPAN)
 - The Global Food Marketplace (Salon International de l'alimentation, SIAL) and
 - Gulfood.

C. Coordination, public relations, promotion and marketing of the project

The Consultant shall

- (a) Assist BIFFL to coordinate with MoInd, governmental organizations such as the executing partners, business associations, and donor partners for the Project implementation;
- (b) Assist BIFFL in preparing such publicity materials as brochure and advertisement for the Project, and
- (c) Assist BIFFL, in promoting the Project in use of the above-mentioned publicity materials through such channels as BAPA, SMEF and BSCIC.

Chapter 4. Expected Time Schedule

The total duration of consulting services will be 60 months. The implementation schedule expected is as shown in Table 1.

Table 1 : Implementation Schedule Expected

Key Activities	Date
Commencement of Consulting Services	September 2021
End of Consulting Services	September 2026

Chapter 5. Staffing (Expertise required)

3 of International Experts and 2 of Local Experts will be engaged, for a total of 58.1 man-months for International Experts and 90.5 man-months for Local Experts. Total consulting input is 148.6 man-months.

(1) Qualification of Key Experts

The qualification of Key Experts is shown in Table 2.

Table 2 : Qualification of Key Experts→Key expert

Designation	Qualification
A1 Team Leader / Financial Specialist	Education: Bachelor degree or higher in the field of Economics, Finance and / or Business Administration Experience: • Working experience: 15 years or more • Experience in finance / banking field: 5 years or more • Experience of working in developing countries • At least 1 experience of Team Leader or Deputy Team Leader • Preference will be given to candidates having financing experience in agribusiness and food processing industries and consulting experiences in two-step loan projects.
A2 Agro-processing specialist	Education: Bachelor degree or higher in the field of agriculture, food science or other related topics. Experience • Working experience: 10 years or more • Experience of Agro-processing, 5 years or more • Experience of working in developing countries
A3 Food safety specialist	Education: Bachelor degree or higher in the field of agriculture, food science or other related topics Experience: • Working Experience: 10 years or more

Designation	Qualification
	• Experience in Food Safety Management: 05 years or more • Experience of working in developing countries
B1 Fund Management / Monitoring & Evaluation Specialist	Education: • Bachelor degree or higher in the field of Economics, Finance and / or Business Administration Experience: • Working experience in finance and banking field : 10 years or more • Experience in monitoring and evaluation: 5 yrs or more
B2 Promotion / Public Relations Specialist	Education: • Bachelor degree or higher in the field of business administration ,business management and other appropriate topics. Experience: • Working experience: 5 years or more • Experience in capacity building: 3 years or more
B3 Fund management Specialist/ Administration Staff	Education: • Bachelor degree or higher in the field of Economics, Finance and / or Business Administration. Experience: • Working experience in Finance and Banking field: 3 years or more

The Consultant may propose other experts and supporting staffs required to accomplish the tasks outlined in the ToR in addition to experts indicated in Table 2 above in this Chapter.

(2) Scope of works for the respective personnel

Detailed information on the major tasks and duties each member of the contaltant team shall perform is provided as follows:

The following table is reference and the Consultant may modify it or propose additional experts to better accomplish the tasks indicated in the TOR.

No	Position	I :International Experts or L: Local Experts	Major Tasks and Duties
International Expert			
A1	Team Leader / Financial Specialist (Key Expert)	I	- To lead Consultant team to perform the jobs as per ToR - To ensure all deliverables are prepared in accordance with quality and time constraints - To assist PIU in facilitating effective management of the Project and control of the funds - To assist the fund planning arrangement for the future operation - To assist PIU to prepare and submit reports on TSL implementation - To assist BIFFL to identify the analytical viewpoints on food safety management of potential and existing borrowers - To organize workshop, seminars or on-the-job training for BIFFL to facilitate the understanding on food safety and agribusiness and food processing industries. - To assist BIFFL and SMEF to prepare and organize training course on food processing and business development. - To assist BIFFL and BAPA to conduct capacity development on export promotion.
A2	Agro-processing specialist (Key Expert)	I	- Assist BIFFL to analyze the market trend of food processing industries - To conduct physical verification of subprojects. - To assist BIFFL to conduct monitoring and evaluation activities. - To assist BIFFL and SMEF to prepare and organize training course on food processing and business development. - To assist BIFFL and BSCIC to prepare and organize training course on food processing of baked goods and edible oil. - To assist BIFFL and BAPA to conduct capacity development on export promotion.
A3	Food safety specialist (Key Expert)	I	Organize workshop, seminars or on-the-job training for BIFFL to facilitate the understanding on food

			safety and agribusiness and food processing industries. To conduct physical verification of the subprojects. - Assist BIFFL and BFSa to prepare and organize food safety management basic training course. - To assist BIFFL and BAPA to prepare and organize food safety management advance training course.
Local Expert			
B1	Monitoring & Evaluation Specialist	L	To assist PIU in conducting monitoring and evaluation including baseline and impact assesmnet on topics through interviews and on-site inspection.
B2	Promotion / Public Relations Specialist	L	- Assist PIU in preparing such publicity materials as brochure and advertisement for the project. - Assist PIU to provide technical assisatnace to canidates of end-user by organizing training programme and seminars.
B3	Fund management Specialist/ Administration Staff	L	- To assist PIU in facilitating effective management of the project and control of the funds. - To Assist the fund planning arrangement for the future operation.

Chapter 6. Reporting

Within the scope of consulting services, the Consultant shall prepare and submit reports and documents to BIFFL as shown in Table 3. The Consultant shall provide electronic copy of each of these reports.

Table 3. Reporting

Category	Type of Report	Timing	No. of Copies
Consultancy Services	Inception Report (including detailed work plan)	Within 1 month after commencement of the services	10
	Quarterly Progress Report	Every quarter	10
	Project Completion Report	At the end of Services	10

Contents to be included in each report are as follows:

- Inception Report: To be submitted within 1 month after the commencement of the services, presenting the methodologies, schedule, organization, etc.
- Quarterly Progress Report: Describes briefly and concisely all activities and progress for the previous quarter by the 10th day of each quarter. Indicates also the work to be performed

during the coming quarter.

- c) Project Completion Report: , to be submitted within one (1) month after completion of consultancy services, which describe all activities together with all seminar materials.

Chapter 7. Obligations of the Executing Agency (Client)

A certain range of arrangements and services shall be provided by BIFFL to the Consultant for smooth implementation of the Consulting Services. In this context, BIFFL shall:

(1) Assistance and exemption

Use its best efforts to, as described in the Sub-Clause 5.1 of General Conditions of Contract:

Assist the Consultant with obtaining work permits and such other documents as shall be necessary to enable the Consultant to perform the Services.

- (a) Assist the Consultant with promptly obtaining, for the Experts and, if appropriate, their eligible dependents, all necessary entry and exit visas, residence permits, exchange permits and any other documents required for their stay in the Client's country while carrying out the Services under the Contract.
- (b) Facilitate prompt clearance through customs of any property required for the Services and of the personal effects of the Experts and their eligible dependents.
- (c) Issue to officials, agents and representatives of the Government all such instructions and information as may be necessary or appropriate for the prompt and effective implementation of the Services.
- (d) Assist the Consultant and the Experts with obtaining exemption from any requirement to register or obtain any permit to practice their profession or to establish themselves either individually or as a corporate entity in the Client's country according to the applicable law in the Client's country.
- (e) Assist the Consultant and the Experts of either of them with obtaining the privilege, pursuant to the applicable law in the Client's country, of bringing into the Client's country reasonable amounts of foreign currency for the purposes of the Services or for the personal use of the Experts and of withdrawing any such amounts as may be earned therein by the Experts in the execution of the Services.

(2) Services, Facilities and Property of BIFFL

Make available to the Consultant and the Experts, for the purposes of the Services and free of any charge, the services, facilities and property in accordance with Sub-Clause 5.4 (a) of General Conditions of Contract, described as follows:

- Provide an office space in the Headquarters of BIFFL with necessary equipment, furniture and utility. However, the Consultant's requirement for office space, including necessary equipment, furniture and utilities, should be clearly stated in the proposal with its rental cost for the case where BIFFL would be unable to provide such facilities.